ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 8: **Understanding the World through Maps and Landforms** | Class 8 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** water bodies	Convention of physical maps
2	**(a)** warm ocean current	Warms north-west Europe
3	**(a)** Mongolia and northern China	A cold desert
4	**(d)** nearly spherical but bulging at the middle	Flattened at the poles
5	**(d)** Challenger Deep in the Mariana Trench	Over 10,000 m deep
6	**(c)** flat, treeless grasslands	Stretch across Eurasia
7	**(a)** preserves shape and direction	Used by sailors
8	**(a)** chemicals in the water	No sunlight reaches there
9	**(b)** Europe and Asia	A natural boundary
10	**(a)** size is greatly distorted near the poles	Distortion in high latitudes

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Nearly spherical shape (1); Bulges at the equator and flattens at the poles (1).	1+1
12	Large stream of water in the ocean (1); Warm and cold currents (1).	1+1
13	Joins Red Sea and Mediterranean (1); Shortens the sea route between Europe and Asia (1).	1+1
14	Earth is curved (1); A curved surface cannot be flattened without distortion (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Blue for water (1); Green for plains (1); Brown for mountains (1).	1+1+1
16	Shelter many species (1); Protect coasts (1); Bleaching and pollution threaten them (1).	1+1+1
17	Vast grasslands (1); Pastoralism (1); Store carbon in soil (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Mercator preserves shape and direction (1); Robinson reduces overall distortion (1); Mercator distorts polar areas (1).	1+1+1
18	Off north-eastern Australia (1); World's largest reef system (1); Hosts many species (1).	1+1+1
	OR: About 2,500 km long (1); Separate Europe and Asia (1); Rich in minerals (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Oblate spheroid (1); Curved surface (1); Mercator (1); Robinson (1); Uses (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Tibetan Plateau features (1); Formation (1); Importance (1); Gobi location (1); People (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	71% and 97% (1); Plankton (1); Climate (1); Food and trade (1); Threats (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Steppes (1); Location (1); Ural features (1); Boundary (1); Resources (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Saying the Mercator map shows true sizes; it preserves direction and shape but distorts size near the poles.
- Mixing the oceans: the Pacific is largest and deepest, the Arctic is smallest and shallowest, and the Southern Ocean encircles Antarctica (the fifth ocean).
- Calling the Gobi a hot desert; it is a cold desert. The Sahara is the largest hot desert.
- Writing that the Urals divide Asia and Africa; they separate Europe and Asia.
- Forgetting that the Tibetan Plateau was formed by the collision of the Indo-Australian and Eurasian plates, which also raised the Himalaya.
- Mixing tundra (treeless plain with permafrost) and steppes (flat, treeless grasslands), or placing the Andes outside South America.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 8: **Understanding the World through Maps and Landforms** | Class 8 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** shelter a quarter of all ocean species	Rich biodiversity
2	**(b)** tundra	Permafrost below
3	**(d)** 71 per cent	Hence the 'blue planet'
4	**(b)** north-eastern Australia	Queensland
5	**(a)** farming, trade and dense population	Fertile and flat
6	**(b)** 97 per cent	Most of the planet's water
7	**(a)** warming and changing ocean chemistry	Climate change
8	**(a)** Alps	Highest peak Mont Blanc
9	**(c)** produce much of the oxygen we breathe	Microscopic ocean life
10	**(a)** the Red Sea and the Mediterranean Sea	Shortens the route to Asia

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Deepest part of oceans (1); In the western Pacific (1).	1+1
12	Permanently frozen ground (1); Found in tundra (1).	1+1
13	Use: shows direction for navigation (1); Limit: distorts size near the poles (1).	1+1
14	Ridge of limestone built by coral polyps (1); Found in warm shallow seas (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Cover 71% of the surface (1); Plankton give oxygen (1); Regulate climate (1).	1+1+1
16	Sheltered water (1); Calm for ships (1); Good for trade (1).	1+1+1
17	Crescent-shaped range (1); Snowy peaks and glaciers (1); Tourism and hydroelectricity (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Pacific, Atlantic, Indian, Arctic, Southern (1); Pacific is largest (1); Arctic is smallest (1).	1+1+1
18	Highest and largest plateau (1); North of the Himalaya (1); Formed by plate collision (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Nomads keep camels (1); Light clothing (1); Oases for water (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Pacific (1); Atlantic (1); Indian (1); Arctic (1); Southern (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Plain features (1); Crops (1); Alps features (1); Rivers (1); Tourism (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Warm and cold currents (1); Gulf Stream (1); Effect on climate (1); Mariana Trench (1); Life there (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Climate (1); Nomads (1); Plants and animals (1); Oasis (1); Nile (1).	1+1+1+1+1

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- Mixing the oceans: the Pacific is largest and deepest, the Arctic is smallest and shallowest, and the Southern Ocean encircles Antarctica (the fifth ocean).
- Calling the Gobi a hot desert; it is a cold desert. The Sahara is the largest hot desert.
- Writing that the Urals divide Asia and Africa; they separate Europe and Asia.
- Forgetting that the Tibetan Plateau was formed by the collision of the Indo-Australian and Eurasian plates, which also raised the Himalaya.
- Mixing tundra (treeless plain with permafrost) and steppes (flat, treeless grasslands), or placing the Andes outside South America.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 8: **Understanding the World through Maps and Landforms** | Class 8 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** Sahara	In northern Africa
2	**(b)** Arctic Ocean	Covered with sea ice
3	**(c)** Bay of Bengal	A large Indian Ocean bay
4	**(c)** Nile	Flows to the Mediterranean
5	**(c)** Pacific Ocean	Covers about one-third of the globe
6	**(b)** it is the highest and largest plateau	Average height over 4,000 m
7	**(d)** South America	Longest continental range
8	**(b)** Southern Ocean	Fifth ocean
9	**(b)** Indo-Australian and Eurasian plates	Also raised the Himalaya
10	**(a)** discarded clothes from fast fashion	Environmental problem

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	A spot in a desert with water (1); Supports vegetation and people (1).	1+1
12	Oceans cover about 71 per cent (1); Seen blue from space (1).	1+1
13	Gulf is a larger, deeper inlet (1); Bay is a smaller, broader inlet (1).	1+1
14	Irrigation (1); Transport and civilisation (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Warm currents warm coasts (1); Cold currents cool them (1); Gulf Stream warms north-west Europe (1).	1+1+1
16	Stores ice and snow (1); Source of major rivers (1); Large freshwater reserve outside the poles (1).	1+1+1
17	Dense evergreen forest (1); Takes in carbon dioxide (1); Releases oxygen (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Near-freezing and dark (1); Great pressure (1); Life uses chemical energy (1).	1+1+1
18	Mongolia and northern China (1); Cold desert (1); Herding is common (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Elk overgrazed the land (1); Wolves were reintroduced in 1995 (1); Balance restored (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Meaning (1); Biodiversity (1); Great Barrier Reef (1); Bleaching (1); Protection (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Andes (1); Aconcagua (1); Amazon (1); Deforestation (1); Protection (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Sea (1); Gulf (1); Bay (1); Strait (1); Canal (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Colorado Plateau (1); Rockies (1); Great Lakes (1); Australian deserts (1); Great Barrier Reef (1).	1+1+1+1+1

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